

CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

POLICY MANUAL

VOLUME 3

Policy: 301.13 Hazard Communication Program

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PURPOSE

This program is intended to serve as a guideline for training and protecting firefighters and for complying with regulatory requirements. The goal of this program is to ensure protection of all members and/or personnel involved in the handling and use of hazardous chemicals.

The Hazard Communication Standard (HCS) is now aligned with the Globally Harmonized System of Classification and Labeling of Chemicals (GHS). This update to the Hazard Communication Standard (HCS) will provide a common and coherent approach to classifying chemicals and communicating hazard information on labels and safety data sheets. This update will also help reduce trade barriers and result in productivity improvements for American businesses that regularly handle, store, and use hazardous chemicals while providing cost savings for American businesses that periodically update safety data sheets and labels for chemicals covered under the hazard communication standard. - <https://www.osha.gov/dsg/hazcom/index.html>

POLICY

All Calimesa Fire Department personnel who may be exposed to hazardous chemicals shall be trained as outlined in this Hazard Communication Program. It shall be the policy of this agency to maintain awareness of all hazardous chemicals encountered by the personnel and to communicate any associated hazards along with the necessary safety precautions.

I. PRINCIPLE REQUIREMENTS OF THE HAZARD COMMUNICATION

STANDARD

- A. Ensure that each container of hazardous chemicals in the workplace is labeled, tagged, or marked with the identity of the chemical and appropriate hazard warnings.
- B. Maintain copies of Safety Data Sheets (SDS) for each hazardous chemical in the workplace and ensure that the SDSs are readily accessible to personnel within the work area where the chemical is being used. 29 CFR 1910.1200 PAR/(G)(8); personnel must have "immediate access" to Safety Data Sheets without barriers.
- C. Provide personnel with specific information regarding hazardous chemicals in their work area at the time of their initial assignment and whenever a new hazard is introduced into their work area. Personnel must be informed of:
 - 1. Requirements of Hazard Communication Standard
 - 2. Any operations in their work area where hazardous chemicals are present, and
 - 3. The location and availability of the written hazard communications program and the SDSs.

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- D. Provide personnel with training regarding hazardous chemicals in their work area at the time of their initial assignment and whenever a new hazard is introduced into their area. The training must include at least:
 - 1. Methods and observations that may be used to detect the presence of a chemical in the work area,
 - 2. Physical and health hazards of chemicals in the work area.
 - 3. Measures personnel can take to protect themselves from those hazards, including proper PPE training provided by the Calimesa Fire Department and
 - 4. Details of the Department's hazard communication program, including an explanation of the SDSs, the labeling system, and the methods for personnel to obtain and use the appropriate hazard.
- E. Develop, implement, and maintain a written hazard communication program. This program must also include a list of the hazardous chemicals known to be present. It must also provide a description of methods that will be used to inform personnel of the hazards of non-routine tasks.

II. CHEMICALS EXEMPTED FROM THE HAZARD COMMUNICATION

STANDARD

- A. Any food, food additive, color additive, drug, or cosmetic, as defined in the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act (21 USC 301 et seq.) are subject to the requirements of that specific act.
- B. Any distilled spirits (beverage alcohols), wine, or malt beverage intended for non-industrial use as defined in the Federal Alcohol Administration Act (27 USC 201 et seq.) are subject to requirements of that specific act.
- C. Any consumer product or hazardous substances as those defined in the Consumer Product Safety Act (15 USC 2051 et seq.) are subject to the requirements of that specific act.
- D. Any hazardous waste defined by the Solid Waste Disposal Act, as amended by the Resource Conservation and Recovery Act of 1976 is subject to regulations under that specific act by the Environmental Protection Agency.
- E. Tobacco or tobacco products.

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- F. Wood or wood products.
- G. Articles which do not release, or otherwise result in exposure to, a hazardous chemical under normal conditions of use are not subject to the Hazard Communications Standard.
- H. Foods, drugs, or cosmetics intended for personal consumption or use in the workplace also are not subject to the Hazard Communications Standard.

III. SAFETY DATA SHEETS (SDS)

- A. Obtain Safety Data Sheets:
A Safety Data Sheet is required for each hazardous chemical on the Workplace Chemical Listing, included in Attachment A1. Chemical manufacturers and suppliers are required to provide a SDS for each chemical provided to a customer. The Fire Chief or Deputy Fire Chief will obtain and provide Safety Data Sheets for all chemicals. For products received directly from the manufacturer or distributor, SDSs will be provided by the manufacturer or distributor. A copy of correspondence requesting SDSs will be maintained in the SDS file until each SDS is supplied.
- B. Maintaining Safety Data Sheets:
Safety Data Sheets, a copy of this written Hazard Communication Program, and a list of hazardous materials (Workplace Chemical Listing) are to be permanently maintained in a notebook or binder in each fire station office area. This will be readily accessible and identifiable to all personnel. An additional notebook or binder must be kept in the work area of the person using the chemicals, in accordance with 29 CFR 1910.1200 PAR/(G)(8).
- C. Updating Safety Data Sheets:
Incoming Safety Data Sheets shall be reviewed by the Company Officer and maintained. If a new SDS has been revised, the old SDS will be transferred to a permanent file. The date of removal shall be written on the old SDS, and it will be placed in a file labeled, "Old Safety Data Sheets." The old SDSs will be maintained thirty (30) years past the duration of any exposed personnel employment.

IV. CONTAINER LABELING

- A. Incoming Containers:
Chemical manufacturers and suppliers are responsible for labeling containers of hazardous chemicals. It is the responsibility of the Company Officer or his/her designee, to ensure that each container arriving at the fire station is labeled or marked.

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legibly with the following information:

1. Identity of material
2. Appropriate hazard warnings
3. Name and address of the chemical manufacturer, supplier, or other responsible party. (*Recommendation only*)

B. Workplace or Temporary Containers:

Hazardous chemicals which are dispensed from the original shipping container must be placed into an appropriate container. The container must contain the following information:

1. Identify of material
2. Appropriate hazard warnings

If a chemical is transferred to a temporary container and is to be used exclusively by one employee during one work shift, it may be used from an unlabeled container. However, if the employee leaves the chemical unattended at any time, then the chemical container must be labeled.

C. Updating of Labels:

If the Fire Department is notified of significant hazard characteristic changes on an updated SDS, the Company Officer shall see that any outdated hazard warnings on labels are corrected to convey the updated information.

V. NON-ROUTINE TASKS

A. Circumstances may require personnel to perform tasks that involve potential exposure to hazardous chemicals which are not in the course of the regular job. Prior to beginning these tasks, personnel must be notified regarding the following:

1. The nature of any hazardous chemicals present. Materials Safety Data Sheets for those chemicals should be reviewed in detail and all recommendations followed in preparing for the tasks.
2. Precautionary measures and protective equipment needed to perform the task.
3. Any hazards associated with chemicals present in unlabeled pipes, such as refrigeration ammonia and propane in distribution systems.

B. When in doubt, the ***Incident Commander*** should be contacted before proceeding with an unfamiliar task which may endanger the member.

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VI. NON-DEPARTMENT PERSONNEL (CONTRACTORS, VISITORS, ETC)

- A. Mutual delivery of chemical hazard information is necessary between the fire department and outside personnel:
 - 1. The Calimesa Fire Department must be informed of all hazardous substances to be brought into the workplace by contractors and/or other personnel.
 - 2. Contractors and/or other personnel must be informed of all hazardous substances they may encounter during their activities in the Fire Department workplace.
- B. It is the responsibility of the Fire Department to inform its personnel and provide any necessary training to deal with chemical hazards brought into the workplace. Likewise, it is a responsibility of the fire department to provide contractors and/or other personnel adequate information on chemical hazards within the workplace. This is necessary so that the contractor can inform and provide his/her personnel with any necessary training. In dealing with contractors or other personnel, the following information shall be exchanged:
 - 1. A list of hazardous chemicals to which they may be exposed while on the job site;
 - 2. Precautions that personnel may take to lessen the possibility of exposure; and
 - 3. The location of SDSs (which must be immediately available).

VII. FIREFIGHTER TRAINING

- A. All personnel of the Calimesa Fire Department are required to receive initial hazard communication training. Personnel who are or may be exposed to hazardous chemicals in the workplace shall receive additional training on each chemical hazard. New personnel shall be trained as soon as possible and before they are assigned to work with hazardous chemicals.
- B. Initial hazard communication training will be conducted by the Company Officer or his/her designee. The initial training shall consist of a brief discussion of all sections of this Hazard Communication Program. The required checklist and information for new employee hazard communication orientation is included as Appendix A3.
- C. Additional training shall be conducted by the Company Officer on specific chemical hazards in each workplace and when a new hazard, not necessarily a new chemical, is introduced into the workplace.
- D. Documented records of training shall be maintained in the official Hazard Communications Notebook containing the training program. Information and records kept in the Hazard Communication Notebook shall include the following:
 - 1. A copy of the Hazard Communications Program
 - 2. A description of training materials and information used.

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3. Completed training rosters with dates training is completed.
- E. Follow-up training shall be conducted by the Company Officer and Training Officer to insure that affected personnel remain aware of the Hazard Communication Standard and its requirements, that they can show where the Safety Data Sheets are located. They must also be generally familiar with the hazardous properties of the chemicals in their work area and understand the protective measures which must be implemented when working with these chemicals.
- F. Follow-up training will be completed annually for all personnel of Calimesa Fire Department

APPENDIX A1

**ASSIGNED RESPONSIBILITIES FOR THE
HAZARD COMMUNICATION PROGRAM**

**Note: More than one member/employee may be assigned as responsible for any of the following. All responsible parties should be listed.*

1. Workplace Listing of Hazardous Chemicals

Responsible for maintaining list of hazardous chemicals in the workplace:

Name:

Position: Fire Chief

2. Safety Data Sheet (SDS)

Responsible for obtaining and maintaining SDSs for all listed hazardous chemicals in the workplace:

Name:

Position: Deputy Fire Chief

3. Labeling

Responsible for ensuring adequate labeling on incoming containers:

Name:

Position: Company Officer

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4. Personnel Training

Responsible for conducting site-specific training initially and annually for all personnel who may be exposed to hazardous chemicals:

Name:

Position: Training Officer

5. Non-Routine Tasks and Non-Departmental Personnel

Responsible for informing personnel and non-Departmental personnel of hazards they may encounter in the fire department:

Name:

Position: Company Officer

APPENDIX A2

WORKPLACE CHEMICAL LISTING
OF HAZARDOUS MATERIALS FOR CALIMESA FIRE DEPARTMENT

Examples:

Diesel Fuel Oil

Gasoline, Unleaded

Firefighting Foam

Oil Absorbent

Cleaning Materials

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APPENDIX A3

HAZARD COMMUNICATION TRAINING FOR NEW PERSONNEL

I certify that I have been instructed about the importance of the following:

1. Personnel rights under the OSHA Hazard Communication Standard
2. The location of the Calimesa Fire Department written Hazard Communications Program.
3. Physical and health hazards of chemicals
4. Location of Safety Data Sheets for chemicals with which I will be working.
5. Safe work practices: how personnel can protect themselves from hazards.
6. How to detect the presence of hazardous substances.
7. Emergency procedures - evacuation, hazardous spills, fire, etc.
8. Emergency first aid techniques.
9. Interpreting SDS Health and Safety Information.
10. Explanation of the labeling system.
11. Explanation, use of, and location of personal protection equipment.
12. Procedures for working with outside contractors and others.
13. Performing non-routine tasks.

I understand the key items and have a working knowledge of the Hazard Communications Program.

Signature

Date

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APPENDIX A4

TRAINING ROSTER FOR

ANNUAL HAZARD COMMUNICATIONS TRAINING

Calimesa Fire Department - STATION _____

Instructor(s) _____

Time of Class: _____ Date: _____

Please sign and print your name to document that you have completed training in OSHA's 29 CFR 1910-1200, Hazard Communications Standard. Training has included information about the Hazard Communications Standard, labeling, SDSs, and the written Hazardous Communications Program.

SIGNATURE

PRINT

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PURPOSE

The Purpose of the Hazard Communication Program is to mitigate employee exposures to hazardous chemical substances per Cal-OSHA Requirements.

CITY OF CALIMESA AND FIRE DEPARTMENT HAZARD COMMUNICATION PROGRAM

The City of Calimesa & Fire Department's Hazard Communication Program is an important part of management's desire to provide employees with a safe working environment. This program is designed to mitigate exposures to employees to hazardous chemical substances. Most of these hazardous substances by definition are most frequently industrial-oriented substances. Substances that do not come under the labeling requirements of this program are listed under the heading, Exceptions, at the end of this Program.

DEFINITIONS

HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCE: Any substance that is a physical hazard or health hazard or is included in the "List of Hazardous Substances" prepared by the Director pursuant to Labor Code section 6382.

HEALTH HAZARD: A substance for which there is statistically significant evidence based on at least one study conducted in accordance with established scientific principles that acute or chronic health effects may occur in exposed employees.

PHYSICAL HAZARD: A substance for which there is scientifically valid evidence that it is a combustible liquid, a compressed gas, explosive, flammable, an organic peroxide, an oxidizer, pyrophoric, unstable (reactive) or water reactive.

RESPONSIBLE PERSONS

The Safety Officer is responsible for the implementation and maintenance of the City of Calimesa & Fire Department's Hazard Communication Program.

Responsibilities include:

1. Coordination of Hazard Communication with:
 - a. Internal departments and external contractors to ensure that all facets of the program are properly handled.
 - b. The internal departments to ensure that all employees are adequately trained on their "right-to-know," the specific hazardous substances with which they have to work, and the communication of potential hazards of non-routine tasks.
 - c. Compliance with the acquisition and maintenance of Material Safety Data Sheets (MSDS).

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- d. Implementation of labeling procedures.
- e. Communication of Hazard Communication information to outside contractors.

HAZARD DETERMINATION

The City of Calimesa and Fire Department relies on the manufacturers hazard determination as indicated by the information given in their MSDS.

HAZARDOUS SUBSTANCES INVENTORY

The City of Calimesa and Fire Department has compiled and continues to maintain an inventory of all hazardous substances used in company facilities. A current inventory can be found at the end of this program.

Each department has a current inventory and MSDS that relate to the inventory for the specific department.

LABELS AND WARNINGS

The company or department manager or supervisor ensures that all hazardous chemicals in the facility are properly labeled and updated as necessary.

Labels are required to have the following information:

1. Chemical identity
2. Appropriate hazard warning
3. Name and address of the manufacturer, importer or other responsible party

Management or supervision refers to the corresponding MSDS to assist employees in verifying label information.

Whenever an employee transfers chemicals from a labeled container to a portable container, it is necessary to label the new container with the chemical or common name (whichever is used on the list of hazardous substances and the MSDS) and appropriate warnings including protective measures to be taken when using the chemical.

TRAINING

All employees working with, or who are potentially exposed to, hazardous chemicals receive initial training on the Hazard Communication standard and the safe use of hazardous substances during new employee orientation. When a new hazardous substance is introduced, additional training is provided at that time prior to employees working with the new substance.

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In general, training includes the following information:

1. Summary of the Hazard Communication standard to include employee right-to-know information. According to Section 5194(h)(2)(G), "employees have the right:

- a. To personally receive information regarding hazardous substances to which they are exposed.
- b. For their physician or collective bargaining agent to receive information regarding hazardous substances to which the employee may be exposed.
- c. Against discharge or other discrimination due to the employee's exercise of the rights afforded pursuant to the provisions of the Hazardous Substances Information and Training Act."

2. Review of any operations in their work area where hazardous substances are present or used.

3. Location and availability of the written Hazard Communication program including the list(s) of hazardous substances and MSDS.

4. How to read labels and MSDS.

5. Labeling requirements.

6. Chemical and physical properties of the hazardous materials.

7. Methods that can be used to detect the presence or release of these chemicals (such as monitoring conducted, continuous monitoring, visual appearance or odor of hazardous substances when being released, etc.).

8. Physical hazards of chemicals (potential for fire, etc.).

9. Health hazards, including signs and symptoms of exposure associated with exposure to the chemicals and any medical condition known to be aggravated by exposure.

10. Procedures to protect against hazards; personal protective equipment required and proper use of this equipment; work practices and procedures for emergency response.

The Safety Officer annually reviews the training program. Department heads are asked for their recommendations and their employees' input for improving the training program's content.

An annual refresher course is given to all employees who are directly or indirectly involved in the use of hazardous substances.

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Employees are retrained on a given hazardous substance whenever a new MSDS is received and the new MSDS indicates significantly increased risks to, or measures necessary to protect, employee health as compared to those stated on the previously provided MSDS. Such training is conducted within 30 days of receipt of the new MSDS.

All training is fully documented and maintained for three years.

NON-ROUTINE TASKS

If an employee is asked to perform a task that he or she normally does not perform and the use of a hazardous substance is part of that task that employee is trained by the affected department manager or supervisor on the specifics of that chemical prior to the commencement of work. Such training includes the specific chemical training as discussed above under Training.

CONTRACTORS

The Safety Officer is responsible for ensuring that contractors or vendors are knowledgeable of the hazards of substances that they may encounter in the normal course of their work while working at City of Calimesa and Fire Department. This communication includes being informed of City of Calimesa and Fire Department's labeling system, protective measures, safe handling, and emergency actions to be taken in the event of an exposure.

This communication is given to the contractor or vendor in written form and the contractor or vendor signs that he/she has received this documentation prior to starting work at any City of Calimesa and Fire Department's location.

In addition, prior to a contractor or vendor bringing chemicals on site, the contractor or vendor must provide the management of Calimesa Fire Department with the appropriate hazard information regarding these substances, including the labels used and the precautionary measures to be taken in working with these chemicals.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Managers, supervisors and employees may obtain further information regarding chemicals used within City of Calimesa and Fire Department from their superiors.

Exceptions:

The standards do not require labeling of the following substances under the Hazard Communication Program because these substances fall under other regulations:

1. Pesticides when subject to the labeling requirements issued under the Federal Insecticide, Fungicide and Rodenticide Act (EPA).
2. Foods, food additives, color additives, drugs or cosmetics that come under the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act labeling requirements.

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3. Any distilled spirits that are subject to the labeling requirements of the Federal Alcohol Administration Act.
4. Any consumer product or hazardous substance defined by the Consumer Product Safety Act and the Federal Hazardous Substances Act when they are subject to the labeling requirements of those acts.

RECORD KEEPING

To ensure that City of Calimesa and Fire Department has information about all chemicals that have ever been used in each facility, the following record keeping procedures are complied with:

1. All medical, exposure, monitoring, inspection, MSDS, and relevant program information are maintained for 30 years.
2. Upon receiving a new MSDS, it is dated.
3. Upon taking an old MSDS out of service, it is dated, and filed for 30 years.

In this way, City of Calimesa and Fire Department is able to know exactly what date range a specific chemical was used and who may have been affected by it during that time.